

BRAND FOUNDATIONS / 2026

Carly Clark Zimmer

A practical guide to the typography, color, and visual language behind the brand.

BEHAVIOR CHANGE + BUSINESS COACH

An editorial type system with warmth and authority.

Use contrast intentionally: expressive serif headlines, highly readable serif body copy, and restrained sans-serif labels.

BODONI MODA

Headlines and display text

Bodoni Moda

Big ideas deserve room to breathe.

EB GARAMOND

Body copy, stories, and captions

EB Garamond

Clear, warm language makes complex change feel human and possible.

MONTSERRAT

Navigation, buttons, labels, and eyebrow text

Montserrat

START HERE / WORK WITH CARLY / LEARN MORE

SIGNATURE ACCENT

Cormorant Garamond Light Italic

Reserve this for the CCZ monogram or a rare signature flourish. It is not a general headline or body font.

High contrast, grounded by one unmistakable accent.

Black and white do most of the work. Berry pink signals action, emphasis, and brand recognition. Soft gray gives long pages room to breathe.

SIGNATURE BERRY #991F5D Calls to action, emphasis, and key moments	EDITORIAL BLACK #090909 Primary text and dramatic dark sections
PURE WHITE #FFFFFF Primary canvas and high-contrast type	SOFT NEUTRAL #F4F4F2 Quiet section backgrounds and breathing room
DARK SURFACE #171717 Secondary dark panels and supporting contrast	

SUPPORTING NEUTRALS

#D5D5D2	Light borders
#555555	Borders on dark backgrounds
#777777	Form-field borders
#D7D7D7	Light text on dark backgrounds
#666666	Secondary dark text
#888888	Dim supporting text

Elegant. Editorial. Spacious. Unmistakably Carly.

The brand should feel direct and discerning without becoming cold. Photography and strong typography create the emotion; the layout gives the ideas space.

DO

- + Lead with large serif headlines and generous negative space.
- + Use berry pink selectively for actions and meaningful emphasis.
- + Pair fine rules and quiet neutral backgrounds with strong photography.
- + Keep supporting labels small, uppercase, and carefully tracked.
- + Favor deliberate asymmetry and an editorial rhythm.

AVOID

- + Beige, cream, brown, gold, or unrelated accent colors.
- + Generic SaaS cards, cartoon graphics, and stock illustrations.
- + Gradients, decorative effects, or excessive rounded corners.
- + Using the accent color everywhere until it loses meaning.
- + Crowded layouts that weaken the sense of calm and authority.

*The business can be bold without the brand
becoming loud.*

QUICK APPLICATION RULE

When creating a new page, document, presentation, or graphic: begin with black, white, and space; establish the hierarchy with Bodoni Moda and EB Garamond; then add berry pink only where you want the eye to act or remember.